Manzil

MANZIL

Choose your path. Pick your university. Start your journey.

COMPANY PORTFOLIO

Pakistan's First AI-Guided Academic & Career Pathway Platform

Prepared for Institutional & Strategic Partners

2026

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SECTION 01

Executive Summary

Pakistan is home to one of the largest youth populations in the world, with over 22 million high school students — yet structured academic and career guidance is almost non-existent. Most schools lack counselling resources, private consultants are prohibitively expensive, and students are left to make life-changing academic decisions based on guesswork, hearsay, or social pressure.

Manzil is an academic pathway app that democratizes access to guidance. Students begin with free, gamified assessments that identify their academic strengths, interests, and values. Based on these insights, the platform offers premium features: curated lists of local and international universities, step-by-step admissions roadmaps, and access to a marketplace of vetted tutors and mentors.

By launching first in Pakistan, Manzil captures a massive underserved market and builds a scalable model that can later expand across the Global South.

22M+	5M+	PKR 200K+
High School Students in Pakistan	Preparing for University Annually	Cost of Elite Private Consultants

Why Now

Pakistan's education system is undergoing rapid change — new curricula, an explosion of international university interest, and a generation of students discovering careers their parents never knew existed. Yet the guidance infrastructure has not kept pace. Manzil closes that gap with technology that is affordable, scalable, and built for the local context from day one.

Manzil At a Glance

WHAT

A gamified pathway app combining psychometric assessments with university and tutor matching.

WHO FOR

High school students (ages 14–19) across National, Cambridge, and IB curricula — and the schools and parents supporting them.

HOW IT MAKES MONEY

Freemium subscriptions, a tutoring marketplace commission, and school dashboard licensing.

WHY IT WINS

The only platform building a triangulated student-teacher-parent dataset calibrated specifically to Pakistan.

SECTION 02

The Problem

The majority of students in Pakistan choose their subjects, majors, and universities with little to no structured support — a decision that shapes the rest of their lives.

No Access to Guidance

The majority of schools lack dedicated career counselling staff or structured advisory programs.

Expensive Alternatives

Elite consultants charge upwards of PKR 200,000 (US$700+) per student — out of reach for most families.

Information Asymmetry

Students and parents have little credible information on university options, scholarships, or future career paths.

Cultural Narrowness

Career aspirations are typically limited to “doctor, engineer, lawyer,” ignoring emerging fields like data science, renewable energy, and design.

THE RESULT

Students make uninformed choices — leading to misaligned degrees, wasted resources, and reduced employability across an entire generation.

Why Schools Can't Solve This Alone

Most schools genuinely want to help — but counselling is rarely a funded, full-time role. A single teacher is often asked to advise hundreds of students on top of a full teaching load, with no standardized tools, no shared data across cohorts, and no way to track whether their guidance actually led anywhere. The gap isn't a lack of care. It's a lack of infrastructure.

SECTION 03

Our Solution

Manzil fills the guidance gap with an accessible, engaging, and personalised platform — combining validated psychometric science with a student-friendly, gamified experience, in both English and Urdu.

Free Core Offering

- Fun, interactive assessments in English and Urdu
- Reports showing top academic fields, learning styles, and career matches
- Instant clarity: “These are your strengths, and here's where they could take you.”

Premium Pathway Features

- Dream University Lists — tailored Pakistani & international recommendations
- Admissions Roadmaps — requirements, deadlines, scholarships
- Tutors & Mentors Marketplace — verified prep for SAT, MDCAT, ECAT, IELTS
- School Dashboards — premium cohort guidance accounts

How It Works, At a Glance

Every Manzil journey moves through four layers of insight — interests, values, personality, and skills — before translating that profile into a ranked list of majors, careers, and matching universities. The result feels less like a test and more like a conversation that gets smarter with every answer.

Designed for the Pakistani Classroom

Every part of Manzil — language, examples, currency, curriculum logic — is built around how Pakistani students actually study and apply, not adapted from a Western product. National, Cambridge, and IB students each see eligibility and recommendations tailored to their specific system from the very first question.

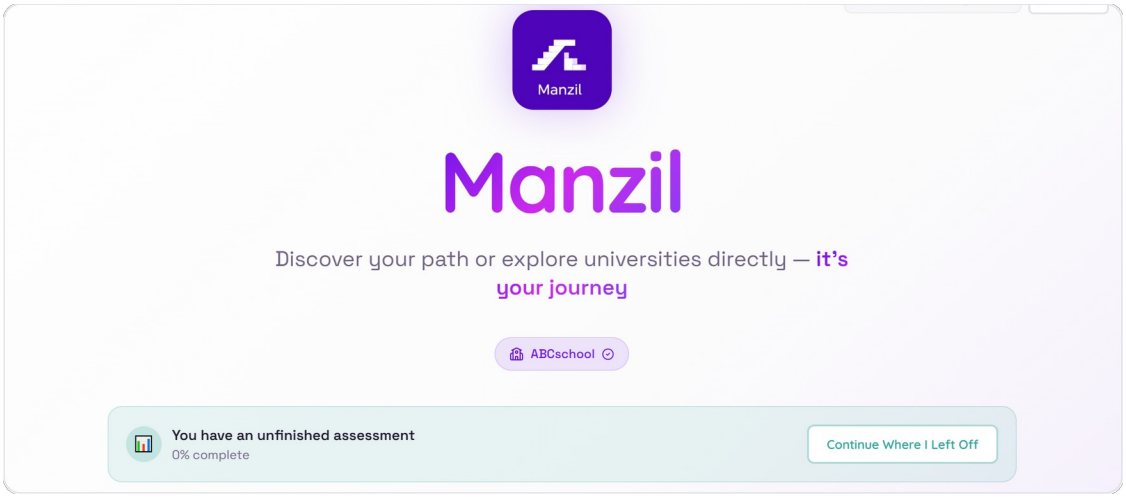
SECTION 04

Product Walkthrough

Manzil's interface is designed to feel light, encouraging, and trustworthy — built so a sixteen-year-old can navigate it alone, and a parent or counsellor can follow along just as easily.

1. A Calm, Guided Home Screen

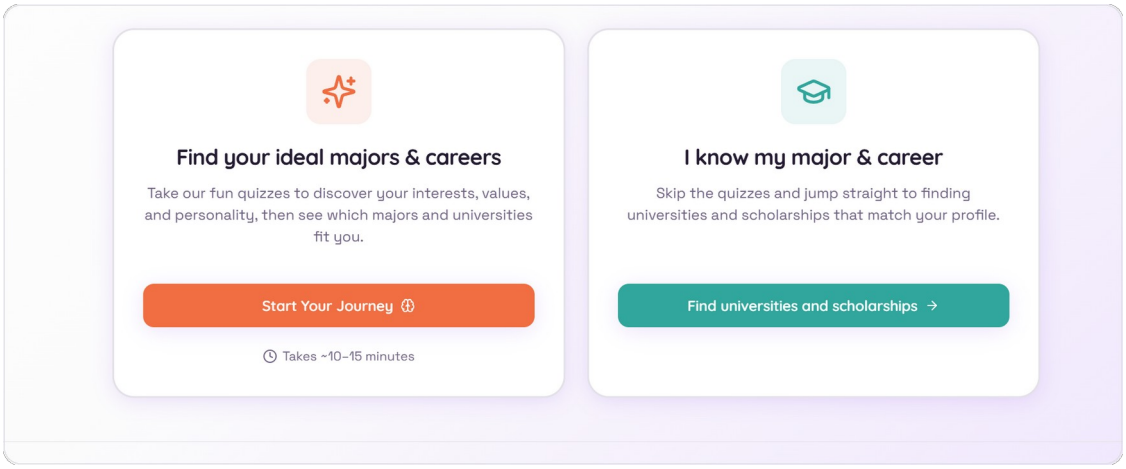
Students land on a clean dashboard that picks up exactly where they left off — reducing drop-off and making every return visit feel like progress, not a restart.



The Manzil home screen — school-verified, progress-aware, and built for return visits.

2. Two Clear Starting Points

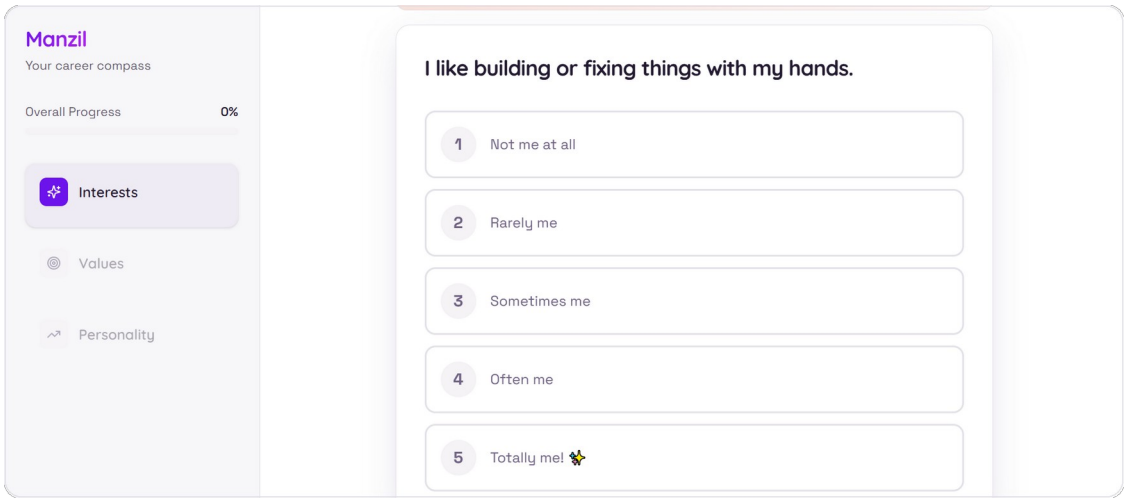
Not every student needs the full discovery journey. Manzil offers two honest paths from the very first screen — respecting the student's own self-awareness rather than forcing everyone through the same funnel.



Students choose: discover their fit, or go straight to university search.

3. Gamified, Bite-Sized Assessments

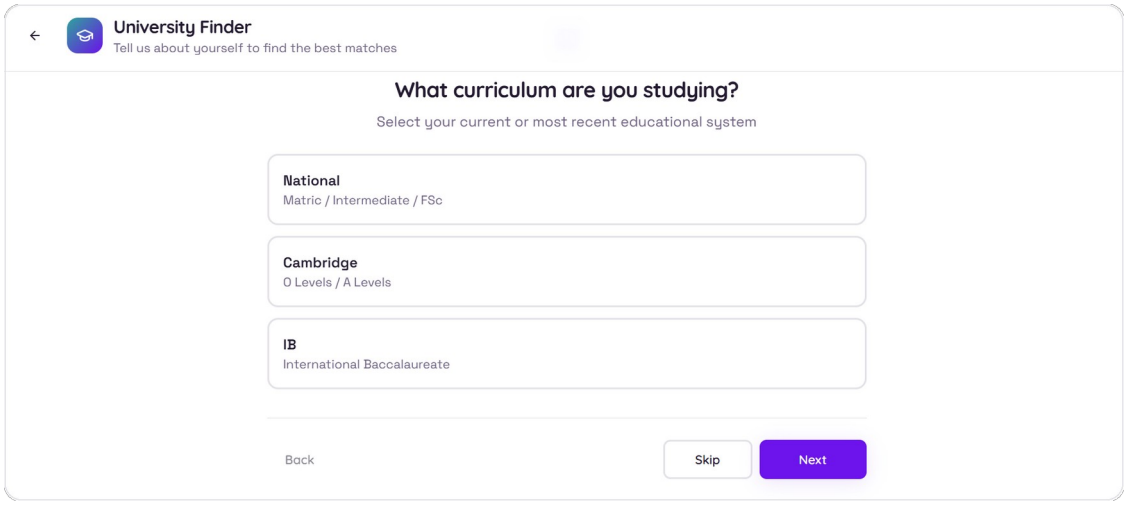
Each question is short, plain-language, and answered on a simple five-point scale — designed to feel like a personality quiz, not an exam. A persistent sidebar shows exactly how far along the student is across Interests, Values, and Personality.



Interest-mapping in progress — calm visual hierarchy, zero clutter.

4. Context-Aware University Search

The University Finder first understands the student's curriculum — National, Cambridge, or IB — so every recommendation that follows is already filtered for eligibility.

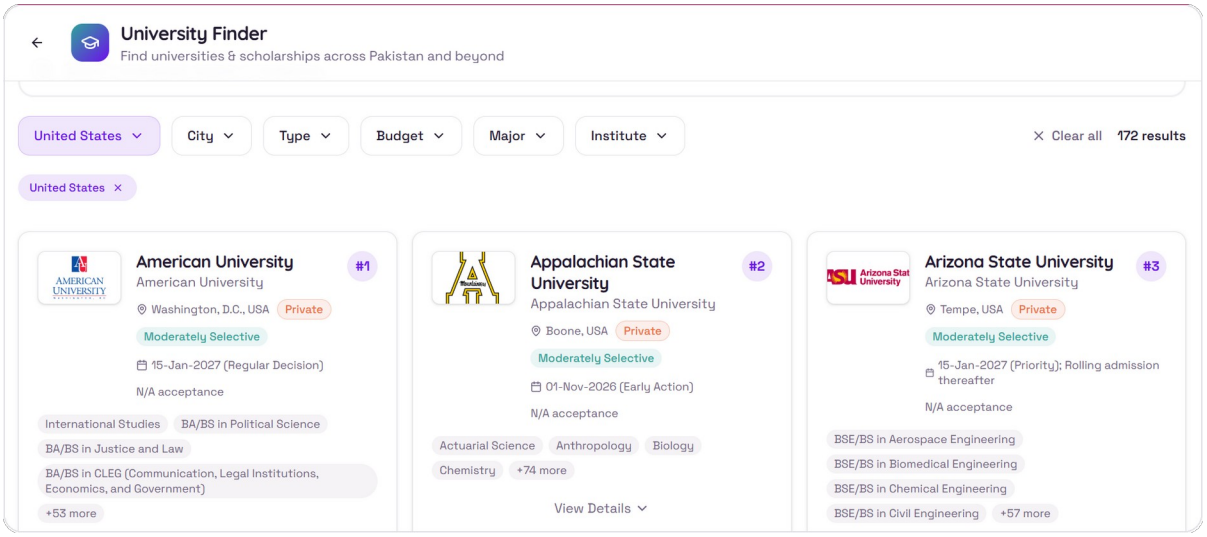


Curriculum-first onboarding ensures relevant, eligible results from the start.

This single design choice — asking curriculum before anything else — quietly eliminates the single biggest source of frustration in university search: being shown programs a student isn't even eligible to apply to.

5. Ranked, Filterable University Results

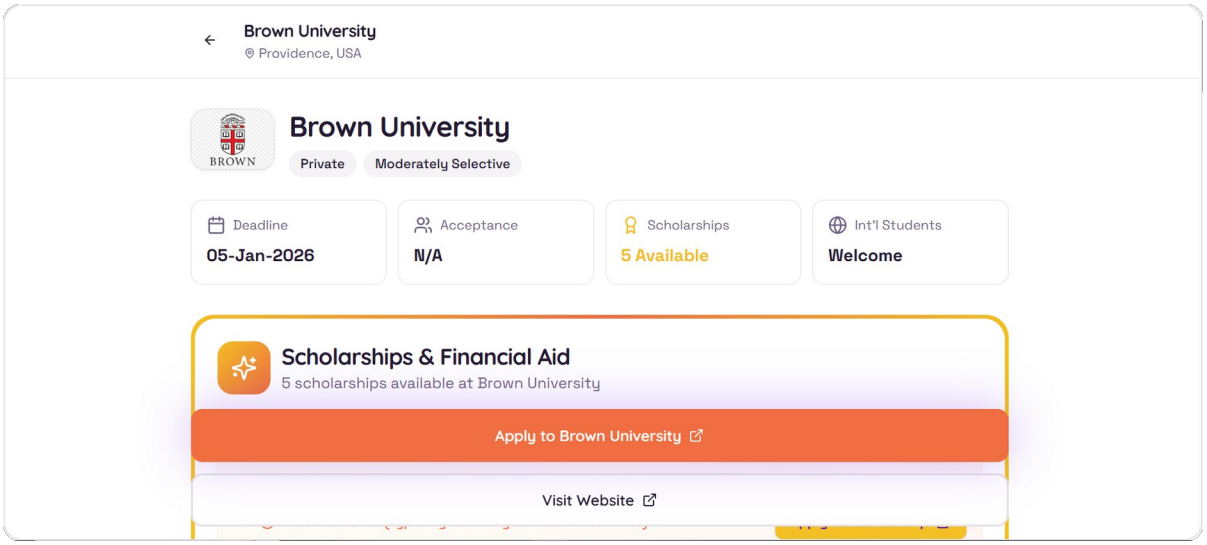
Results are filterable by country, city, type, budget, major, and institute — then ranked, with admissions deadlines and acceptance data surfaced directly on each card.



172 matched programs for a single search — ranked, filterable, and deadline-aware.

6. Deep University Profiles with Built-In Scholarships

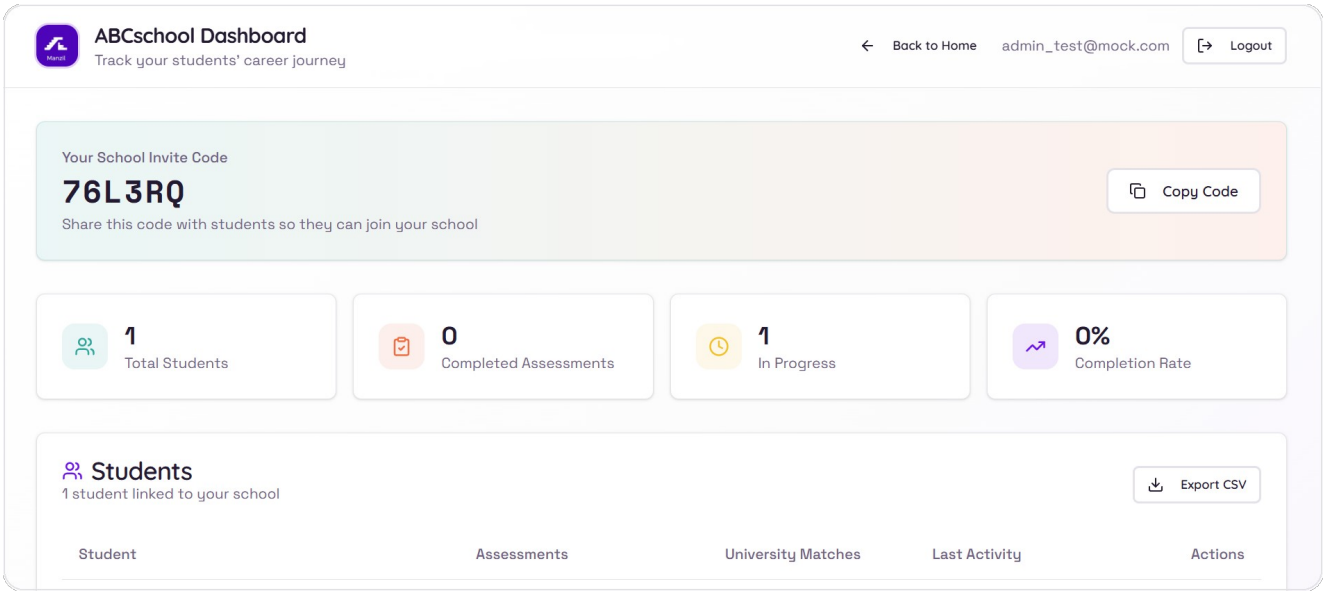
Every university page consolidates the information a family would otherwise pay a consultant to assemble: deadlines, acceptance context, available scholarships, and a direct application link — in one place.



A complete Brown University profile — deadline, scholarships, and a direct apply pathway.

7. School Dashboards for Counsellors

Schools see exactly what counsellors need: an invite code to onboard a cohort, live completion rates, and a roster view of every student's assessment and university-match status — exportable in one click.



The school-side dashboard — cohort tracking built for counsellors, not just admins.

What This Means in Practice

Every screen above ships today — this is not a concept mockup. The product already handles the full loop from student discovery to school-level reporting, which is the foundation the business model in the next section is built on.

Feature Summary

Student App
Assessments, results, university search, saved lists

Tutor Marketplace
Verified mentors for SAT, MDCAT, ECAT, IELTS, essays

School Dashboard
Cohort tracking, invite codes, CSV export

SECTION 05

The Assessment Engine

Manzil's recommendations are not guesswork — they are built on three validated psychological frameworks, layered together into a single weighted score for every major and career path.

01 **Interest Mapping** *Holland RIASEC Model*

A shortened, gamified 48-item version of John Holland's Occupational Themes test sorts students into six interest types — Realistic, Investigative, Artistic, Social, Enterprising, Conventional — surfacing the fields they will naturally enjoy, e.g. "Investigative + Social → medicine, data science, teaching, research."

02 **Values Mapping** *Schwartz Personal Values Theory*

A 30-item survey based on Schwartz & Boehnke's validated values model scores students across ten dimensions — from Stimulation and Achievement to Security and Tradition — revealing what genuinely motivates each student: stability, impact, creativity, or growth.

03 **Personality Snapshot** *Mini Big Five Inventory*

A condensed Big Five assessment measures Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism, building a learning-style and work-style profile — e.g. "You thrive in structured environments, prefer independent work, and have strong verbal reasoning."

04 **Career Awareness Boost** *Pakistan Add-On (Optional)*

A localized module introduces "hidden careers" — AI, fintech, climate science, policy, design — deliberately broadening student horizons beyond the traditional "doctor, engineer, lawyer" track.

The Scoring Model

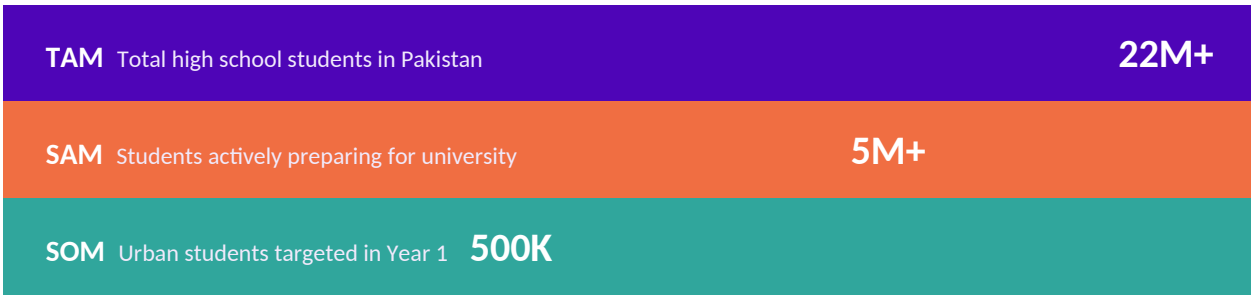
Each layer acts as a successive filter. Interests select the broad universe of careers a student would enjoy; values rank those careers by what matters most to the student; personality fine-tunes the final list by fit and work style.

50%	30%	20%
Interests	**Values**	**Personality**
Holland RIASEC fit — the first and widest filter	Schwartz dimensions — ranks by what truly motivates	Big Five traits — final fine-tuning for work style

SECTION 06

Market Opportunity

Pakistan is the launchpad before scaling globally — a single, enormous, underserved market that proves the model before it travels.



Market Tailwinds

Rising EdTech Adoption

Smartphone and internet penetration among Pakistani teens continues to climb, making app-based guidance viable at national scale.

Growing International Ambition

More Pakistani families are actively pursuing study-abroad and scholarship pathways than ever before.

Counsellor Shortage

Public and even most private schools have no dedicated, trained career counselling staff — a structural gap, not a temporary one.

No Dominant Local Player

No existing platform offers a tri-layer, psychometrically grounded guidance product built specifically for the Pakistani curriculum landscape.

Beyond Pakistan

The same structural gap — large youth populations, thin counselling infrastructure, and rising study-abroad ambition — exists across much of South Asia, the Middle East, and Sub-Saharan Africa. Once Manzil's model is proven and its dataset mature in Pakistan, the same engine, recalibrated to local curricula and job markets, becomes the template for entry into these adjacent markets.

SECTION 07

Business Model

A four-stream model that starts free, builds trust, and monetizes the moments students and schools need help the most.

01

Free Entry

Free assessments drive mass adoption. Every student receives their top 3 recommended academic fields and careers at no cost — the foundation of trust the entire model is built on.

02

Premium Subscriptions

Unlocks hidden careers, a tailored list of universities and scholarships (locally and internationally), and full admissions requirements and deadlines for every “dream university.”

03

Tutoring Marketplace

Commission earned on every booked session with verified tutors and mentors across SAT, MDCAT, ECAT, IELTS, and essay preparation.

04

School Partnerships

Bulk licensing of premium dashboards — giving schools cohort-level analytics, counsellor tools, and a visible commitment to student guidance.

Why the Funnel Works

Each stream feeds the next. Free assessments build the user base and the proprietary dataset; premium subscriptions monetize the families ready to act on those results; the marketplace and school partnerships then layer in recurring, higher-margin revenue on top of an audience Manzil no longer has to pay to acquire.

SECTION 08

Competitive Moat

Manzil's defensibility isn't a feature — it's a compounding data asset. Three multiplier effects turn every user into a contributor to a dataset no competitor can replicate.

The Teacher Multiplier

STRONGER DATA, EVERY YEAR

Short teacher-facing forms rate each student's curiosity, collaboration, discipline, creativity, and observed strengths. Comparing teacher ratings against student self-assessment results strengthens Manzil's model with every classroom that adopts it — turning the platform into part of the school's own framework, not just an app students use once.

The Ecosystem Lock-In

STUDENT + TEACHER + PARENT

Parents receive a simplified values-and-strengths quiz and a "Parent–Student Fit Report" — think Spotify Blend, but for academic alignment. Parents love the clarity, schools love a tool that brings parents on board, and no other platform in Pakistan holds this triangulated three-layer dataset. That triangulation is the moat.

The Living Engine

ANNUAL RECALIBRATION

A psychometric model that never updates eventually dies. Pakistan's job market is changing faster than the West's — so every year, Manzil analyses aggregate platform data, identifies new patterns, adjusts scoring weights, and adds emerging fields such as AI, fintech, and climate science. The result is a model tuned specifically to Pakistani and Global South norms — a dataset that cannot be copied by LinkedIn, Coursera, or any foreign player.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is how Manzil becomes part of the education system — not just an app inside it.

The Compounding Effect

Each multiplier reinforces the other two: better teacher data makes the parent reports more credible; richer parent engagement increases school retention; deeper school retention generates more annual data to recalibrate the model. A competitor entering a year later isn't just behind on users — they are behind on the dataset itself, and that gap widens every admissions cycle.

SECTION 09

Go-To-Market Strategy

A deliberately sequenced rollout — proving the model with schools before scaling direct-to-student, then layering in revenue partners.

PHASE 01

Pilot With Schools

Launch with 20–30 schools across major cities, embedding Manzil into existing counselling workflows and gathering the first triangulated student-teacher-parent datasets.

PHASE 02

Direct-to-Student Campaigns

Scale awareness through TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube — channels where Pakistani students already spend their time — to drive organic, free-tier adoption.

PHASE 03

Onboard Tutors & Test-Prep Academies

Build out the marketplace side of the business by bringing verified tutors and academies onto the platform, activating the commission-based revenue stream.

PHASE 04

Expand Tier 2 Cities & Add Int'l Universities

Extend beyond major urban centers and deepen the international university database — widening both the addressable market and the premium value proposition.

What Success Looks Like in the Pilot

20–30

Partner schools onboarded in Phase 1

70%+

Target assessment completion rate per cohort

100%

Pilot schools free — no cost, no obligation

SECTION 10

Impact & Vision

Manzil equalizes access to guidance across socioeconomic groups, helps students pursue aligned degrees, and strengthens Pakistan's talent pipeline — positioning the country as a launchpad for globally scalable EdTech innovation.

- Closes the guidance gap for the 99% of students who will never afford a PKR 200,000 consultant.
- Reduces costly degree-switching and dropout by surfacing genuine fit before enrollment, not after.
- Broadens career aspirations beyond “doctor, engineer, lawyer” into the fields actually growing today.
- Gives schools an evidence-based counselling tool that strengthens — not replaces — their existing staff.
- Builds the first large-scale, triangulated student-teacher-parent dataset calibrated to Pakistan and the wider Global South.

> **OUR VISION**
>
> *A future where every student — regardless of city, income, or school — chooses their path with clarity, not guesswork.*

The Five-Year North Star

From Pakistan to the Region

A guidance engine proven nationally, then recalibrated and exported to neighbouring Global South markets facing the same counselling gap.

From an App to an Institution

Embedded so deeply in school workflows — through teachers, parents, and annual data — that Manzil becomes infrastructure, not just software.

SECTION 11

Founding Team



Oneir Raza

Co-Founder, Manzil

Passionate and results-driven development professional with a strong background in education, policy research, and EdTech. Chevening Scholar with extensive experience managing and executing high-impact projects across diverse sectors — adept at stakeholder engagement, data analysis, and strategic communication, with a focus on creating sustainable development solutions.

CAMBRIDGE GRADUATE	CHEVENING SCHOLAR	EDTECH & POLICY RESEARCH

Why This Team

Manzil sits at the intersection of education policy, data, and product — exactly where it needs to. A founding background in development and policy research means the platform is being built with the rigor of an evidence-based program, not just the speed of a typical consumer app, while staying grounded in the lived realities of Pakistani students and schools.

Building the Team

Manzil is actively growing its founding team and advisory circle — particularly in product engineering, data science, and school partnerships. If you or someone in your network shares the mission of bringing structured guidance to every Pakistani student, we'd welcome the conversation.

SECTION 12

Get In Touch

Manzil is currently engaging with schools, education networks, and strategic partners across Pakistan. If you'd like to bring structured, evidence-based guidance to your students — or explore a partnership — we'd love to talk.

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PILOT PROGRAM	Free for the first cohort of partner schools — no obligation after the pilot.

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